

Exploring Sinatra

This basic introduction to Sinatra can be used by interested readers as a starting point, from where they can move on to the vast resources online.



Ruby, a mature language, is used in many applications but Web development is what it is mostly used for. Whenever someone recommends Ruby for Web development, the first thing that comes to mind is Ruby on Rails. Granted, it's a great Web framework for rapid prototyping, and has excellent documentation, tooling and community, but there are times when using Rails is an overkill—like when you want a simple solution without having to navigate between files and directories and just want the work done. Or, when you want a quick solution to a problem but don't want to fiddle through configurations. For such cases, Sinatra might be the right tool for you.

Sinatra is named after the famous American singer and actor, Frank Sinatra. It was designed and developed by Blake Mizerany, with a huge list of contributors and backing from many companies like Travis CI. Sinatra is a library and not a framework, which means it doesn't do many things under the hood and let's you handle the logic, which is a great thing if you want control.

Installation

Sinatra is easy to install. The only obvious requirement is Ruby. If you don't have Ruby installed, try *rbenv* or *rvm*, both

of which let you manage and install multiple Ruby versions. Installing it is as easy as using the following command:

```
gem install sinatra
```

Basic use cases

Sinatra is a DSL (domain specific language), which helps in reducing the effort to churn out a Web application. To run Sinatra locally, there is no configuration needed.

```
require 'sinatra'
```

```
# Associates Root of the website with following code block
when a get request is processed
```

```
get '/' do
  "Hello World"
End
```

Sinatra executes a code block by matching it with an HTTP verb like GET, POST and a URL location like */user/important*. In the above example, when some program makes a GET request to the root */*, it will execute the code block and